

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, clouds and sun, humid, high 84. **Tonight**, a thunderstorm early, cloudy, low 65. **Tomorrow**, breezy, cooler, less humid, partly sunny, high 76. Weather map, Page A24.



ANA MARIA AREVALO GOSEN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Giving Birth in the Shadows
Fearing deportation at Dominican Republic hospitals, Haitian women are having babies in squalid, unsupervised settings. Page A6.

U.S. JUDGES DENY MAP IN ALABAMA

**Redraw Is Called Biased
Against Black Voters**

**By EMILY COCHRANE
and ABBIE VANSICKLE**
A panel of federal judges on Tuesday rejected Alabama’s effort to use a new voting map for the November midterm elections, saying that the districts discriminated against Black people and could not be used so shortly before a vote.

Alabama’s attorney general, Steve Marshall, announced in a court filing Tuesday afternoon that he would immediately appeal to the Supreme Court, which last month ruled that a Louisiana congressional map drawn to create two majority-Black House districts was an unconstitutional racial gerrymander. Gov. Kay Ivey, a Republican, has already set special primaries in August in four House districts that would be affected by Alabama’s new congressional map.

The ruling further confuses the electoral landscape across the South, as Republican-led legislatures have raced to implement new district lines after the Supreme Court narrowed the Voting Rights Act of 1965. It also demonstrates how the ruling from the nation’s highest court has further muddled how lower courts interpret the landmark civil rights law.

And in the seesaw battle over redistricting ahead of the midterms, Democrats seeking control of the House got two wins on Tuesday, the ruling in Alabama, plus the decision by South Carolina state senators to adjourn without drawing up a new map to eliminate that state’s one majority-Black House seat. With thousands of votes already cast on the first day of South Carolina’s early voting, there was no longer enough support among Republicans to push through new district lines before the state’s June 9 primary [Page A15].

If the Supreme Court takes up the Alabama case, it will be the first major test of the high court’s

Continued on Page A17

Showdown in Texas

Coverage of the Republican primary runoff for Senate between the incumbent, John Cornyn, and Ken Paxton is at nytimes.com.

When Justice Is Politicized, Courts Are Resisting

By ALAN FEUER

Grand juries are the heart of the criminal justice system, the inner sanctum where prosecutors, working unchecked and in secret, have enormous power to indict their fellow citizens.

But under President Trump, the Justice Department has had serious difficulties presenting cases to grand juries, running into problems that would have seemed unthinkable a year ago.

In the past several months, prosecutors have repeatedly failed to persuade grand juries that the cases they have brought warrant criminal charges. And if it were not unusual enough, they

Push to Charge Trump’s Foes Flounders After Legal Missteps

have also been admonished at least three times since last November by federal judges who have accused them of misconduct.

The latest setback came in Chicago, where a judge cited a remarkable list of grand jury errors in a case that was dismissed against four Democratic activists about to face trial for impeding the police during a protest last fall at a suburban immigration detention

facility.

The blunders shocked the judge, April M. Perry, who recounted from the bench on Thursday how prosecutors had spoken to grand jurors outside the grand jury room — a major breach of protocol — and had improperly coached them that the evidence they had presented was particularly strong.

The prosecutors also stacked the deck in their own favor by removing from the panel some grand jurors who had voted against them when considering an earlier version of the charges. Making matters even worse, they tried to hide these maneuvers by

Continued on Page A14

SONNY ROLLINS, 1930-2026

Genre-Hopping Colossus of the Jazz Saxophone

By PETER KEEPNEWS

Sonny Rollins, whose forceful and imaginative approach to the tenor saxophone made him one of the dominant jazz musicians of the post-World War II era, died on Monday at his home in Woodstock, N.Y. He was 95.

His death was announced in a statement from his publicist, Terri Hinte.

Even by the standards of a musician that prizes individuality, Mr. Rollins stood out, as both a musician and a personality.

In the late 1940s, when most young jazz saxophonists favored a light tone with minimal vibrato, he developed a fat, full-bodied sound that was a throwback to the older style of Coleman Hawkins, the first great tenor saxophonist in jazz. In the late 1950s, when his career as a bandleader was just getting off the ground, Mr. Rollins abruptly began a hiatus that lasted more than two years — mostly, he explained later, because he was not satisfied with the quality of his playing.

Mr. Rollins came of age when a new kind of jazz known as bebop was in ascendance, and from the start his playing was suffused with bebop’s harmonic sophistication and rhythmic daring. To classify him as a bebopper, however, would be an oversimplification.

Over the years he flirted with the avant-garde, jazz-rock fusion and other styles. But with his ferocious energy, his penchant for playing the unexpected note at the unexpected moment, and his



STEPHANIE BERGER FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Sonny Rollins in 2006. For years, he sought “the ultimate sound.”

unusual sound — sometimes harsh and mocking, sometimes lush and romantic — he was ultimately unclassifiable.

“The music I play is too big to be put into any one style,” he told an interviewer in 2002. “Every time I pick up the horn, I want to hear

something fresh.”

That commitment to freshness was the key to Mr. Rollins’s approach, and to his appeal. The jazz critic Francis Davis wrote in 2000 that Mr. Rollins “is the greatest living jazz improviser, and if we

Continued on Page A20

Iran Threatens Strikes After U.S. Hits Targets Near Strait of Hormuz

**A Kinship With Kyiv:
Underdogs Bite**

By LARA JAKES

The trench warfare and heavy artillery on Ukraine’s battlefields in 2022 don’t look much like the war by air and sea that began when the United States and Israel attacked Iran.

But similarities between the two conflicts soon became evident and remain so almost three months later.

In both, the country with the more powerful military has been unable to vanquish its adversary. President Vladimir V. Putin of Russia expected a quick victory when he launched his “special military operation,” more than four years ago. President Trump initially vowed that the “little excursion” against Iran, which started on Feb. 28, would last four to five weeks.

“For both Russia and for the United States, there’s a lot of unmet expectations about their military operations,” said Nicole Grajewski, an expert on Iran and Russia and a professor at Sciences Po, the elite social sciences university in Paris, attributing it to “the hubris on both sides.”

Over the last several days, negotiations have produced progress toward an initial plan for peace between Iran and the United States, though with much uncertainty, given the renewed American strikes against Iran on Monday.

Whether or not an agreement is reached, the war will have provided lessons, along with the conflict in Ukraine, on the evolution of modern warfare.

Asymmetrical tactics have helped both Ukraine and Iran hold off stronger forces against which they could not compete in a conventional military confrontation.

Iran struck at the United States by attacking its allies. It instilled fear in Persian Gulf states by sending one-way attack drones to hit military bases and energy facilities in countries like Kuwait and Saudi Arabia. It has also used the threat of mines and small armed speedboats to keep a chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz, a shipping lane for 20 percent of the global energy supply.

Ukraine has assassinated Russian military officials in Moscow and regularly struck oil facilities, the lifeblood of the Russian economy. It has also used sea drones to neutralize Russia’s much bigger Black Sea navy.

Perhaps most indelibly, experts

Continued on Page A9

**Renewed Hostilities
Might Derail Talks**

This article is by Max Bearak, Erika Solomon, Euan Ward and Michael Levenson.

Iran’s Islamic Revolutionary Guards Corps said on Tuesday that it would launch a “decisive reciprocal response” to any attack that violated the cease-fire, injecting more uncertainty into fragile diplomatic efforts a day after the U.S. military struck targets in southern Iran.

Iran’s supreme leader, Mojtaba Khamenei, also suggested that the country could renew strikes on U.S. military installations in the Persian Gulf, which Tehran had repeatedly targeted after the United States and Israel started bombing Iran in late February.

“The hands of time do not turn backward, and the nations and lands of the region will no longer serve as shields for American



ARASH KHAMOOSH/POLARIS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A photo of Iran’s new supreme leader at a ceremony in Tehran.

bases,” Mr. Khamenei wrote in a statement released to commemorate the start of the hajj, the annual Muslim pilgrimage to Mecca.

The Iranian warnings came after U.S. forces struck missile launch sites in southern Iran and destroyed two Revolutionary Guard speedboats that U.S. officials said were trying to place mines in the Strait of Hormuz, the Persian Gulf waterway that is a critical transit route for crude oil and natural gas.

Two American officials, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss operational matters, said that in the 24 hours preceding the U.S. strikes, Iran had launched attack drones near some of the nearly two dozen U.S. Navy warships in or around the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea. The ships are enforcing a blockade on vessels trying to enter or

Continued on Page A9

Museum Wall Text Is Thrown Into a Self-Censorship Debate

By ZACHARY SMALL and ROBIN POGREBIN

There are compelling images of American life currently on display at the Smithsonian’s National Portrait Gallery: photographs of a nude woman receiving a medical injection, a child’s empty bedroom, a man’s vacant expression.

For many of them, the artists had drawn up language to help viewers further understand their intentions and methods.

But the gallery’s “Outwin Boochever Portrait Competition” show — which runs through August — is largely devoid of the descriptive wall text that typically accompanies artworks on display. Many artists received notice last summer that such text would not be part of the exhibition.

“I was frustrated,” said the photographer Jared Soares, who won second prize for his image of a Black man who had been falsely

accused of a crime after being misidentified by facial recognition technology. “It strips the photograph of its context and it is no longer grounded in the story.”

Wall text has become a flashpoint for debate as the language used by the Smithsonian, and other museums, is scrutinized for the way it presents context.

The Trump White House has demanded that eight Smithsonian institutions — including the Portrait Gallery — turn over thousands of documents (including wall texts) for review as part of an effort to replace “divisive or ideologically driven language with unifying, historically accurate and constructive descriptions.”

Concetta Duncan, a Portrait Gallery spokeswoman, said wall text was avoided in the competi-

Continued on Page A12



NATIONAL A11-19
A Bleak Summer of Drought
After a dry winter, towns in the West are warning residents that they could soon run out of water. PAGE A11

When Does Duty Cross a Line?
The sentencing of Matthew Perry’s assistant has some considering the power dynamics involved. PAGE A18

INTERNATIONAL A4-10
Fighting Fires With Wine
Certain landscapes, including vineyards, can stem the spread of wildfires. A “Fire Wine” designation is being awarded to some winemakers in Spain. PAGE A8

A Russian Enclave in Thailand
Thousands who fled after the invasion of Ukraine ended up on Phuket. Local resentment is growing. PAGE A4

BUSINESS B1-5
Pedal Power for That Last Mile
Delivery companies use cargo e-bikes to take on New York traffic. Amazon plans to try them in other cities. PAGE B1



SPORTS B6-9
‘They Are Crazy’
A Knicks player’s diagnosis of the team’s fans was illustrated as New York reached the N.B.A. finals. PAGE B6

It’s All in the Timing
Stolen bases have surged since M.L.B.’s 2023 debut of the pitch clock, which has emboldened slower players. PAGE B9

FOOD D1-8
Only the Best for Them
Some people have their hearts and stomachs set on dining at every top-ranked restaurant they can. It’s a small group, as it requires a fat wallet and considerable digestive stamina. PAGE D8

Fine Bleacher Dining
Whether it’s a spaghetti dinner or 20 hamburgers, baseball fans have been bringing their own meals to the stadium for decades. But the old-fashioned hot dog is still hard to beat. PAGE D5

OPINION A22-23
Bret Stephens PAGE A23



ARTS C1-6
‘The Maids,’ Reconsidered
In a new version of a classic work about class and power, Kip Williams ponders “a world that gives you every opportunity not to be yourself.” PAGE C1



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